

SOP-ERGO-3200: Ergonomics and Manual Material Handling

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs ergonomic hazard assessment and manual material handling limits to reduce musculoskeletal injury risk.

Section 2. Manual Lifting Limits

Clause 2.1 — Manual lifting of loads over 50 lbs by a single person is discouraged; mechanical assist (hoist, cart, lift table) is required for loads over 75 lbs regardless of team-lift availability.

Clause 2.2 — A two-person team lift requires both individuals to be trained on coordinated lifting technique; team lift capacity is not simply the sum of two individual lift limits.

Section 3. Workstation Assessment

Clause 3.1 — A workstation ergonomic assessment is triggered by an employee report of discomfort, a musculoskeletal injury in that role, or introduction of a new task/tool — assessed by Occupational Health within 15 business days of the trigger.

Section 4. Repetitive Task Controls

Clause 4.1 — A task identified as high-repetition/high-force through assessment requires engineering controls (tool redesign, workstation adjustment) as the primary control; job rotation is an acceptable interim control only, not a substitute for engineering correction.

Section 5. Records

Clause 5.1 — Ergonomic assessments and resulting corrective actions are filed to the Occupational Health File and retained for 5 years.